

Participant: 1, Postdoc, on-site.

Test record:

The participant first chose the travel example as the optimisation scenario.

Homepage:

The participant is not clear about what to optimize. But when she got to the second page on How-it-works, she said her confusion was solved and knew what this optimization meant.

Specify page:

The participant chooses the travel example as the optimisation scenario, and adds another variable "cost".

When got to the objective page, the participant noticed the "cost" objective as an example already exists. But she didn't remove it, keeping the "cost" and "satisfaction" objectives.

Optimize:

During optimization, she valued the cost objective based on the mapping of the cost variable number. After 3 evaluation rounds, she clicked "I am done".

Result page:

Only one best alternative is presented and she said she can understand that result is the optimal because she evaluated it as optimal.

Because of the duplication of variables and objectives in the first test, I asked her to start over again.

For the second time, she chooses daily budget planning as the optimisation scenario.

Specify page:

The participant added variables "Clothes cost euro" and "Food cost euro", and for the objectives, she added "Total cost" and "Satisfaction".

Optimize:

During optimization, the participant brought out that she didn't have too many ideas about what variable to optimize in mind, she wished to see more hints or recommendations.

Result page:

Two options are displayed because of the Pareto optimal, the participant said she didn't understand in the beginning why there are 2 options on the result page but after the explanation she understood. She thinks the information about the tradeoff was clear and enough here, but information on how more than 1 options are shown shall be displayed.

Problem summary:

- The participant did not have a clear understanding of optimization at the beginning but then more clear by checking the diagram.
- The travel example shows there might need to change;
- This user tends to include objectives in the variables specifying.
- The user might need inspiration for input what variables for optimization.
- On the results page, the user doesn't understand why certain optimal solutions is provided.

